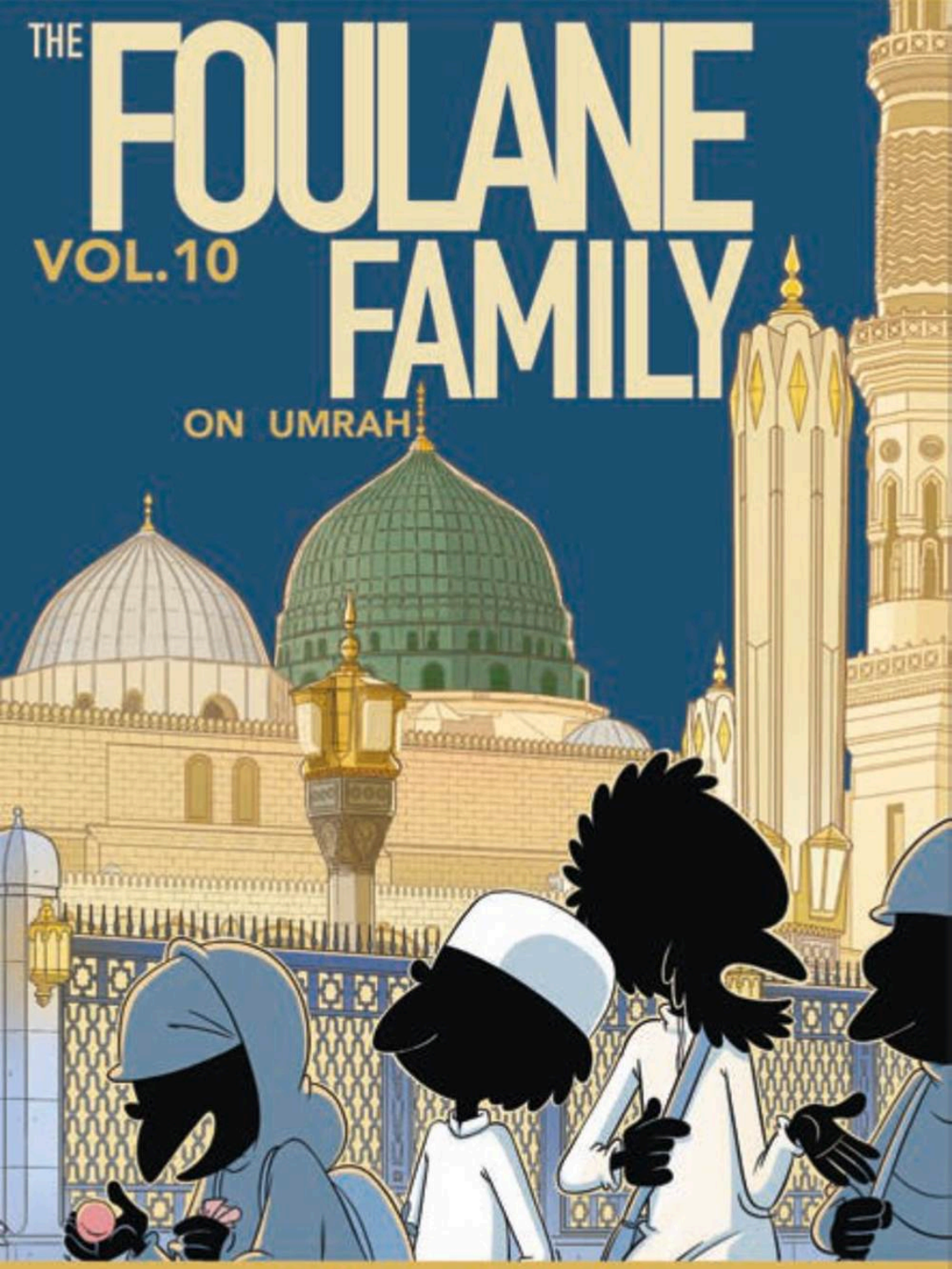
# THE FOULANE FAMILY

## VOL.10

## ON UMRAH



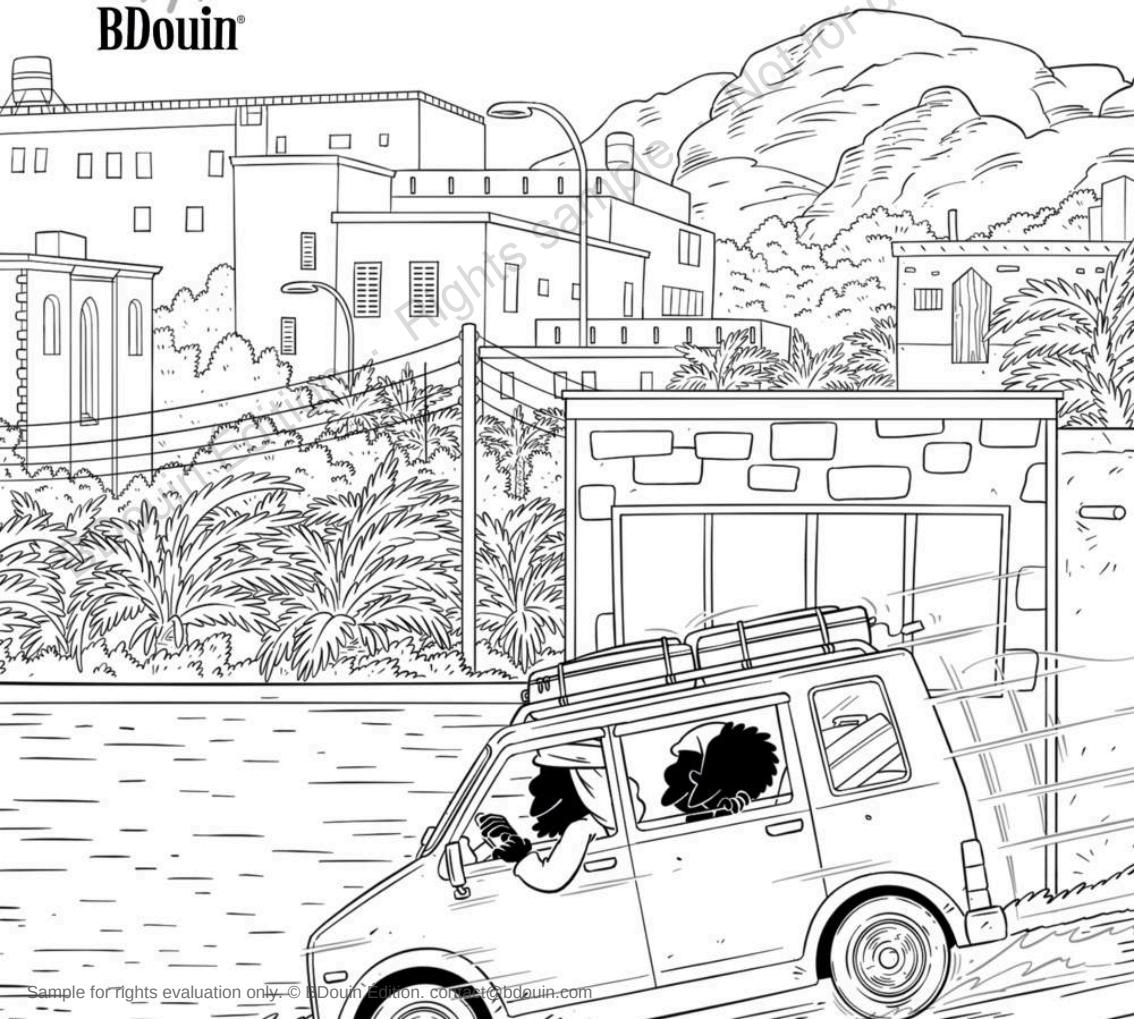
## PART 1 : MADINAH

Vol.10 In Umrah
Part 1: Medina

# THE FOULANE FAMILY

Written by
**Norédine Allam**
Illustrations
**Studio BDouin**
Editorial Director
**Karim Allam**

BDouin®



Rights sample - Not for distribution
Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Edition. contact@bdouin.com

# 1. In the Clouds

BDouin Édition · Rights sample · Not for distribution

Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

Gazing out of the airplane window, watching the wings cut through the vast sky and glide past the clouds, is an incredible experience. Especially for someone like me, who dreams of becoming a pilot one day, insha'Allah!



BDouin Édition - Rights reserve - Not for distribution

As I watched the plane's movements closely, fascinated by every detail, Binti leaned in and whispered, trying to be discreet. She was hatching a plan to use the screens in front of us, even though we weren't allowed to turn them on.

"Listen", she said, lowering her voice. "I've tried everything, but Oummi won't even listen to me anymore. She might agree if you ask her..."

"But I don't want to watch a movie!" I whispered back.



Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

“Yes, but think about me!” Binti replied, her voice pleading. “They’ve got that new cartoon about the princess with the super long hair on the kids’ playlist. Please! I really, really want to watch it!”

“Fine, fine...” I muttered, leaning forward towards Oummi in the seat ahead, ready to plead on Binti’s behalf.



“Oummi, can me and Binti..?”

“NO!” She cut me off before I could finish.

“But... I haven’t even...”

“I already said NO to your sister! No cartoons during the trip!” she added, turning back towards us.

I sat back down next to Binti.



Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com



“Children...” Oummi began, her tone gentle but firm, “this trip is deeply significant. We’ve been waiting for this moment for years. We’re going with the intention of renewing and strengthening our faith. Remember, the Prophet, sallallahu ‘alayhi wa sallam, said, ‘Faith returns to Medina like a snake retreats to its hole’. Let’s make the most of every precious moment and avoid unnecessary distractions.”

“But Oummi, we haven’t even arrived yet!” Binti protested, her voice tinged with a hint of frustration.



Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

"Yes, but the journey began the moment we left our home!" Oummi explained, "We pray that Allah rewards us for every step we take. To earn that reward, we need to stay fully focused on our purpose, which is to...?"

"... Please Allah!" I answered proudly.



"Exactly! So, instead of watching things you can catch up on later, let's focus all our energy on this important goal. Agreed, my children?"

"Agreed, Oummi!," I replied.



Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

"Alright, alright..." Binti sighed, pulling a small book from her bag. "I will go over the steps of performing Umrah and the special prayers with my little BDouin Guide instead."

"Barakallahu fikum!" Oummi replied with a warm smile. "And I'll try to wake your father—looks like the meal is on its way!"



After that little reminder, I went back to looking at the world from up high. This time, I did what Oummi said and whispered dhikr while I did it.



Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com



“Medina, Mecca,
Here we come!
Insha’Allah.”



Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

# 2. First Impressions

BDouin Édition · Rights sample · Not for distribution

Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com



The moment we stepped off the plane, Medina's warmth hugged us like an old friend.

A breeze unlike any other brushed against us—impossible to describe, both gentle and full of energy.

Oummi felt it too.

"Masha'Allah! Can you feel it, kids?" she said as she walked down the airplane's stairs lifting her head to embrace the atmosphere.

"Sniff, sniff... I only smell petrol," Binti remarked with a scrunched-up nose.



Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

"Oh no!" Oummi chuckled. "It's not just about smelling but also feeling. Sensing the depth of history that fills this sacred land!"

"Yes, I can feel it!" I exclaimed, drawing in a deep breath.



"Come on, everyone! We need to move quickly!" Abi called out, waiting for us at the bottom of the stairs.



BDouin Édition · Rights sample · No further distribution

Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

The moment our feet hit the ground, we hurried through a maze of corridors, lifts and seemingly endless escalators before finally arriving at customs.

Then, still in a rush, we joined other travellers circling a conveyor belt, anxiously scanning the endless stream of suitcases, hoping to spot ours!




Fortunately, Binti had the brilliant idea of tying a small pink ribbon on each handle, making our suitcases easy to find.

With everything finally in hand, we took a moment to catch our breath and looked up. We were taken by surprise at what we saw.



Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com



We had rushed off the plane so quickly that we hadn't noticed the view around us.

But now, standing still, we couldn't believe what we saw. The Medina airport was huge! Its big steel arches looked just like tall palm trees, bending gracefully.

Sunlight poured in through large windows, lighting up the entire space to welcome people from all over the world, coming here with hopes and prayers. Masha'Allah!

"If you think the airport is amazing, just wait until you see Masjid Al Nabawi!" Abi said with a smile, clearly excited to show us more.



BDouin Edition - Rights sample - Not for distribution

Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

And so, we set off again, this time moving towards the exit, where we spotted our guide – Abou Layla.

He held up a small cardboard sign with 'FAMILY FOULANE' written in Arabic. Abi's friend, someone he trusted a lot, had highly recommended him to us.




Short in stature, broad-shouldered, with a thick black beard covering his face, he wore a long beige thobe, a ghutra – a headscarf – on his head and sandals on his feet, blending seamlessly with his surroundings.

Abi stepped forward to confirm that we were the family he had come to meet.



Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

“Salam alaykum!” he exclaimed, wrapping Abi in such a powerful hug that it nearly took his breath away.



“Wa... Wa’alaykum salam!” Abi managed to mutter.

“So, how was your trip? Or rather, your flight?” he asked.

“Very good, alhamdulillah!” answered Abi.

I then stepped forward to introduce myself, but he already seemed to know me.

“Ha! You must be Walad? The brave knight! Ha! Ha!”



BDouin Edition - Rights saturn - Not for distribution

Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com